

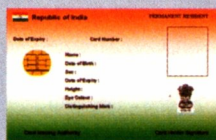
STALLED REFORMS

POLICE MODERNISATION

The Home Ministry set aside Rs 1,300 crore for modernisation of police in 2008-09. This was for better mobility, modern weaponry, communication systems, training infrastructure, forensic science facilities, strengthening of intelligence branches, security equipment and more police stations.

PROBLEMS

- No accountability on part of the states.
- No system to check how states are spending the funds.



MULTIPURPOSE NATIONAL IDENTITY CARDS

Launched in 2002, all bonafide citizens were to be issued these to create a national identity, increase security and facilitate e-governance. Even with an estimated budget of Rs 5,000 crore, only 12 lakh identity cards have been issued. The project has started in Assam, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Gujarat, Delhi, Rajasthan, Uttarakhand, J&K, Goa, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Tripura and Pondicherry.

PROBLEMS

- Sifting real citizens from illegal immigrants.
- By the time it is completed, technology would be obsolete.

MEGA CITY POLICING

Launched in 2005, it is a part of police modernisation but Home

Secretary Madhukar Gupta wants it as a stand-alone scheme. Though 35 cities qualify, the Home Ministry has so far covered only Mumbai, Bangalore, Delhi, Hyderabad, Chennai, Kolkata and Ahmedabad for more focused policing. The Rs 127-crore assistance is for procuring modern policing systems.

PROBLEMS

- Terrorists too are focusing on these cities and exposing the gaps in the present system.
- There is still no serious attempt to strengthen intelligence, the key requirement.

INTELLIGENCE FLOW

A laid-down mechanism for monthly interactions between the IB and its field operative in charge, generally a Joint Director. The JD gets information from officers who are supposed to have their ears to the ground, and also coordinates with state police and their intelligence units.

PROBLEMS

- Field officers should be 30,000 but number 3,500.
- State intelligence units almost defunct.

STATE POLICE STRENGTH

The problem is that the strength is far less than developed countries. On an average, India has 126 police personnel per 1,00,000 people. In Western Europe, it is between 300 to 500.

PROBLEMS

- Strength in sensitive states is lower than national average.
- Bihar has the worst ratio of 57 per lakh, while Naxal-infested Malkangiri in Orissa has only 17 sub-inspectors.

SIPRA DAS



APPEASEMENT POLITICS: (L to R) Paswan, Mulayam and Lalu eye minority votebanks

Under pressure, Manmohan favours STRICTER TERROR laws but it could cost votes.

Manmohan that National Security Adviser M.K. Narayanan wrote to Home Minister Shivraj Patil, asking him to give the green signal to Gujarat Control of Organised Crime Act (GUJCOCA), and also to similar laws being sought by other states including Rajasthan, Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. The prime minister had been getting inputs regularly from intelligence and security agencies about the urgent need for a stringent anti-terror law, albeit a sensitive one to prevent further alienation of the Muslim community.

Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi had met the prime minister on August 29, 2008, urging him to clear GUJCOCA, pending before the Centre for past four years. Neighbouring Maharashtra had a similar law, MOCOCA, and that there was no logic in denying Gujarat its anti-terror law. Narayanan was present during the meeting at Modi's special request. It was soon after the meeting that the NSA had shot off the letter to the home minister, saying that there was no reason for the Centre to stop states from getting own anti-terror laws. Incidentally, it was during the same meeting that Modi had cautioned the Centre about the terror threat to Delhi. And later, when the blasts happened, he milked it for all it was worth. Modi may have scored political brownie points by the public revelation but it also, yet again, brought into focus the hurdles caused by the politics of terror. ■